OEKO-TEX® Association
General Manager Meeting

20st – 21nd October 2022, Rome

Minutes

Persons present (GMs and representatives in alphabetical order):

On-site: Matz Bachmann (TESTEX), Vicente Blanes (AITEX), Inga Bleyer (OEKO-TEX® Zurich), Dr Grazia Cerini (CENTROCOT), Braz Costa (CITEVE), Georg Dieners (OEKO-TEX® Zurich), Stephen Donnelly (SHIRLEY), Dr Stefan Droste (HOHENSTEIN), Dr Radoslaw Dziuba (IW), Dr Jean-Pierre Haug (TESTEX), Dr Heike Illing-Günther (STFI), Christina Jönsson (RISE), Dr Dominik Kinschel (OEKO-TEX® Zurich), Pavol Kopecny (VUTCH), Jan Laperre (CENTEXBEL), Robert Löcker (OETI), Alisia Mätz (OEKO-TEX® Zurich), Prof Dr Stefan Mecheels (HOHENSTEIN), Lene Jul Östblom (RISE), Dr Livia Kokas Palicska (INNOVATEXT), Clarisse Reille (IFTH), Elisa Rimmele (OEKO-TEX® Zurich), Johnny Rodam (DTI), Rainer Roten (TESTEX), Athanasios Stamou (Mirtec), Prof Dr Haiko Schulz (FILK), Melanie Teuteberg (OEKO-TEX® Zurich), Toshiaki Yamazaki (NISSENKEN)

Virtual participants: OEKO-TEX® Team
Speakers: Coty Jeronimus (Quantis), Dr Timo Hammer (Hohenstein)

Preparation of minutes: OEKO-TEX® Team Zurich

Welcome

Mr Dieners, General Secretary of the OEKO-TEX® Association and chairperson of the General Manager Meeting, officially welcomes all people present and gives a note of thanks to CENTROCOT for organizing the 2022 meeting. He thanked all members of the OEKO-TEX® Association for the good cooperation and fruitful discussions of the past year.

The meeting was opened, 20th October 9am.

1. Welcome of the new General Manager colleagues

New institute GMs that introduced themselves:

- IFTH: Clarisse Reille introduces herself as new CEO.
- Mirtec: Athanasios Stamou introduces himself as the new CEO.
- NISSENKEN: Toshiaki Yamazaki took the position as CEO over in April 2022.
- VUTCH: Pavol Kopecny introduces himself as the new CEO.
- STFI: Dr Heike Illing-Günther participates for the first time this year.

2. Minutes: General Manager Meeting 2021

The minutes of last year´s virtual General Manager Meeting in Madrid (21st - 22nd October 2021) were accepted unanimously.

3. Annual Report 21/22

A summary of the new OEKO-TEX® Annual Report for the business year 2021/2022 was presented. The English version of the report has been distributed and is uploaded to the OEKO-TEX® Website.

- OEKO-TEX® ECO PASSPORT: A new record of 16,000 certified products was achieved.
- STeP Impact Calculator: Supports the path to more sustainability and strengthens our product portfolio
- Stakeholder Management: A new strategy is being worked out to drive the stakeholder management further.
- OEKO-TEX® Travel compensation: 57,820 kg of CO2 was compensated in the last business year, due to Covid19 travelling was still reduced.

4. Portfolio Statistics

The last business year was a very successful year for OEKO-TEX®, under the given circumstances of the COVID-19 pandemic and economic challenges. Further details can be found in the presentation.

5. Reports of the Institutes

(Alphabetical order)

5.1 AITEX

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	1921 (+3.5%)	489
LEATHER STANDARD	2	1
STeP (active cert.)	70 (from 53 last year)	-
MADE IN GREEN	820 (number of labels)	-
ECO PASSPORT	79 (from 54 last year)	9
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

Distribution of Product class

- No significant changes

Distribution of Annex

- No significant changes

Suggestion for STeP:

- Stronger enforce suggested changes and come back after a fixed time to check for the implementation of the suggested changes.

PR activities are presented (LinkedIn, seminars, social media, etc.)

- AITEX magazine, webinars
- Trade fairs: (A+A in Düsseldorf) & in Pakistan (seminars)

New facility with 30,000 m^2. The move in will be in 2023.

5.2 Centexbel

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	858	244
LEATHER STANDARD	4	-
STeP (active cert.)	24	-
MADE IN GREEN	49 (number of labels)	-
ECO PASSPORT	23 (+3 from last year)	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

Challenges:

Increase in costs (wages +18% since October 2021 and Energy costs, from 10k to 60k per month)

Investments for OEKO-TEX®:

- Humidity accessory for Markes micro-chambers
- GC with high resolution MS
- Equipment for total fluorine

Circular Economy:

EU Ambition: by 2030 textile products placed on the EU marked are long-lived and recyclable, ...
Definition of "recyclable" is missing

REACH4TEXTILES

- Project to train EU market surveillance agencies for detecting non-compliant REACH textiles entering Europe.
- Risk-based sampling strategies

- First results were presented.

Suggestions, questions, comments:
OEKO-TEX® (GD) Feedback on the ambitions of the EU: OEKO-TEX® is working on a strategy and details regarding Circular Economy and recycled materials now.

5.3 CENTROCOT

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	1211 (121 recyceld materials)	204
LEATHER STANDARD	6	1
STeP (active cert.)	32	-
MADE IN GREEN	197 (number of labels)	-
ECO PASSPORT	58	6
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- 35 years anniversary
- An impressive growth of ECO PASSPORT was presented, +107%, due to demand for ZDHC compliance
- New laboratories: Biodegradability, Multi-lab for recycling with the goals to gain knowledge in circular economy and sustainability (see slides for details).

Marketing activities:

- 670 subscribers of the traditional newsletter about OEKO-TEX®
- Social Media: Use of Facebook was started and the posts of OEKO-TEX® are reposted, currently 615 followers. LinkedIn is better, 6265 followers, also here the posts of OEKO-TEX® are reposted. Instagram is work in progress.

Challenges:

- Outlook for the Italian textile fashion industry – A decrease is forecasted.

Suggestions, questions, comments:

FILK, HS: What is the reason that the Leather industry does not want to work with Centrocot?

- ➔ CENTROCOT, GC: The customers have a certification from the Italian Leather Association, it is easy and cheap. It is a very closed community. Discussions happened, but they do not accept OEKO-TEX® limit values.
- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, GD: OEKO-TEX® is perceived as a competitor by the Italian Leather Association.

5.4 Citeve

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	1153 (53 from annex 6) in 2021 and 1300 in 2022 (to expect)	241
LEATHER STANDARD	0	1
STeP (active cert.)	3 in 2021 / 5 in 2022 (to be expected by end of the year)	-
MADE IN GREEN	3	-
ECO PASSPORT	6	10
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Recovering with the number of audits after Covid 19
- Challenge of the decade – Lack of HR – 100 more people needed next year due to new building and another new construction of 7000 m2 (battery recycling research)
- Big drive for the near future – Bioeconomy, Digital transition and decarbonisation
- Shoe industry was approach, but not successfully – resistant for certification

Suggestions, questions, comments:

TESTEX, JH: What is meant by DPP?

➔ CITEVE, BC: Digital product passport. It will be implemented, but how it will look like is still open. How can the information be presented to different stakeholders? How can we help companies to implement something like this and the big challenge – harmonization. Proposes in the context of the stakeholder management to point to EU what OT can provide. It is common to believe in blockchain as a potential technology. One further challenge – how do we ensure that the information is correct.

HTTI, SM: How is the development in Brazil?

- CITEVE, BC: lack of commercial agreements with EU. But prices are good and textile industry really strong.
- OEKO-TEX®, GD: digital product passport is very interesting. Higg – data model is a new business model.
- TESTEX, MB: digital solutions – technical solutions – in the eyes the EU also in the context of the green deal, the plan is not to use virgin fibers anymore. And 95% of OEKO-TEX® turnover is STANDARD 100 and it is very much related to recycling and how it is handled by OEKO-TEX®. It would be nice to create a new business model in the blockchain, but this is not highest priority.

5.5 DTI

DANISH TECHNOLOGICAL INSTITUTE

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	161 (+20.4%)	15
LEATHER STANDARD	-	-
STeP (active cert.)	4 (6 new customer in process)	5
MADE IN GREEN	No information provided	-
ECO PASSPORT	-	-
DETOX TO ZERO	1	-

General information:

- Challenge: more manpower is needed. Audits are still behind schedule.
- Very high interest in sustainability & social responsibility
- Marketing activities: 3 seminars, involvement in public procurement, sustainability projects.
- 2 new consultants for OEKO-TEX® by the end of this year/beginning of next year
- MADE IN GREEN is time intensive, so the effort beyond providing the manual is charged to the customers

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.6 Filk

FILK Freiberg Institute

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	2	-
LEATHER STANDARD	14 (3 new, 1 stopped)	-
STeP (active cert.)	1 (1 in progress)	-
MADE IN GREEN	-	-
ECO PASSPORT	1	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Change in personal Dr. Ute Morgenstern retires and Dr. Ines Stachel takes over
- Many ECHA activities in Leather sector (Glutardialdehye, Chrome (IV) and Bispenol A und F)
- Presentation of the results of the survey done by ILM
- Important upcoming topics are traceability (animal welfare, deforestation), biodegradability and bio-based chemicals
- Strong competition with LWG
- Overtaking of PFI is nearly finished
- Several marketing activities but change as the certificate is not so important in the market. Strategy is to have brands and groups recognize the LEATHER STANDARD in the specification
- Great success: Bundeswehr specification for LEATHER STANDARD
- success from LEATHER STANDARD certificate, now STeP, next step is MADE IN GREEN, conscious decision against LWG à very supportive customer relationship.
- Increase of activities within the German leather market.
- No cooperation with the LWG – they are the competition, not a cooperation.

Suggestions, questions, comments:

CENTROCOT, GC: Traceing of hides: Tanneries want to have traceability, but the traders in between are an issue.

HTTI, SD: PFI shoe label?

- ➔ FILK, HS: No information

5.7 HOHENSTEIN

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	11183	2430
LEATHER STANDARD		1
STeP (active cert.)	454	-
MADE IN GREEN	262 (labels 3713)	-
ECO PASSPORT	428	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Expansion of team (balance sales and technical knowhow)
- Need to pick up on audits.
- Support for customer events from OEKO-TEX® is very important and appreciated.
- STANDARD 100: Growth is based as well on the distinguishing between real and unreal certificates (sister certificates)

ECO PASSPORT

- No active demand for ECO PASSPORT from customers
- ECO PASSPORT chemical industry is a growing market, growth rate in testing sector.
- ECO PASSPORT is picking up speed and linking with other OEKO-TEX® products are necessary

LEATHER STANDARD

- LOWA shoes are LEATHER STANDARD certified (lengthy process +1 year)
- LEATHER STANDARD demand from customers must be increased
- Expertise for LEATHER materials are very valuable for OEKO-TEX® to gain

ORGANIC COTTON / Recycling

- GMO/Recycling moving to slow?
- Controlling the material flow is necessary to stay relevant
- ORGANIC COTTON: must be within the crop cycle – learning: effort for pilots is a lot
- ORGANIC COTTON connection with ECO PASSPORT
- Full integration into of ORGANIC COTTON into MADE IN GREEN is needed
- Contact with Textile exchange how can we be another relevant option for recycling?

Suggestions, questions, comments:

Hohenstein, SD: Are we moving fast enough to keep up with the market?

CENTRCOT, GC: Are we going to certify the ginner?

➔ OEKO-TEX®, DK: Yes, like STANDARD 100. Chain of custody and transaction certificates are coming soon

RISE, CJ: Possibility for secondary raw material stream? Would be very nice and process is similar.

➔ OEKO-TEX®, DK: It is planned is to start with GMO and then move on to recycling

Shirley, SD: How is HTTI handle MADE IN GREEN? Does HTTI charge?

➔ HTTI, SD: No, it is open to the institute to charge

5.8 IFTH

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	530 (+5 %)	156
LEATHER STANDARD		-
STeP (active cert.)	+300 %	-
MADE IN GREEN	6 (Label owners)	-
ECO PASSPORT	1	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Importance of sustainability within France (rising awareness)
- New regulation concerning sustainability aspects which is mandatory for company with >50 b turnover
- ECO PASSPORT is too expensive
- Growth with STeP
- Many new MADE IN GREEN labels
- Many communication and marketing activities (PV, webinars, newsletter)
- Social media impacts
- Plan to expand business

Suggestions, questions, comments:

OEKO-TEX®, GD: France is an important market and brand focus is increasing

5.9 INNOVATEXT

INNOVATEXT®

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	96	24 (8 for HTTI)
LEATHER STANDARD		-
STeP (active cert.)	14	11
MADE IN GREEN	30	-
ECO PASSPORT		-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Economic crisis in Hungary as well (high gas prices)
- Audits are mostly done on-site, self-assessments are still not very much appreciated
- Marketing: workshops, textile magazines, trade fairs, TV, webinars, podcasts, …
- Social media: LinkedIn, Facebook
- Workshop for LEATHER STANDARD and new leaflet in Hungary
- MADE IN GREEN label which is sold by Arena and Otto

Challenges:

- EU Textile strategy: is OEKO-TEX® accepted?
- How to improve LEATHER STANDARD and shoe business?
- Are recycling and circularity new products options for OEKO-TEX®

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.10 IW

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	240	32
LEATHER STANDARD		-
STeP (active cert.)	6	-
MADE IN GREEN	3	-
ECO PASSPORT		-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- In 2022 merged with Lukasiewicz
- Short introduction of the new institute and the new possibilities
- Different promotion via different channels

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.11 Mirtec

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	98	9
LEATHER STANDARD		-
STeP (active cert.)	2	-
MADE IN GREEN		-
ECO PASSPORT		-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Introduction of the Greece textile sector
- On-Site Visits are delayed (planned to be done by end of 2022)
- Marketing efforts: trade fairs, coals media, public procurement

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.12 Nissenken

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	468	52
LEATHER STANDARD		-
STeP (active cert.)	0 (but many requests)	-
MADE IN GREEN	4	-
ECO PASSPORT	33	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- New representative
- COVID impact is still massive in Japan
- Many requests for webinars
- Interest in STeP and LEATHER STANDARD
- Marketing efforts were there: trade fairs were however canceled due to covid
- Governmental pressure towards sustainability

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.13 Oeti

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	988	253
LEATHER STANDARD	10	-
STeP (active cert.)	50	-
MADE IN GREEN	240 (labels)	-
ECO PASSPORT	20	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Great difference about the results of the control testing
- Social media focus on LinkedIn
- Long lasting customer were awarded
- Fair activities were limited
- Expansion into India and Bangladesh, and PPE
- Biobased sneakers – success story (also took +1 year)
- Shoes should be a separate category
- Recycling application is not definite enough and clearer communication possibilities for recycling must be available
- Impact calculator and RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS are big opportunities
- Amazon climate pledge friendly and STANDARD 100– risky, greenwashing, cannibalization of MADE IN GREEN, increased work with trader without generating business.

Suggestions, questions, comments:

- none

5.14 RISE

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	Ca. 100 (5 more than compared to last year)	3
LEATHER STANDARD	-	-
STeP (active cert.)	-	-
MADE IN GREEN	-	-
ECO PASSPORT	?	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Sweden is affected by the crisis and therefore also Rise.
- Interest in OEKO-TEX is increasing
- Resources are tight regarding person power
- Leather Standard recently implemented (no certifications yet)
- Steady/same interest in STD 100 - Low interest in ANNEX 6
- Steady/same interest in STeP (but no facilities in Sweden, rather outside of Sweden interested)
- Increased numbers of ECO PASSPORT certificates

Marketing Activities:

- 3 seminars and upcoming planned

Targets:

- Push for STeP and increase no. of on-site visits

Suggestions, questions, comments:

OEKO-TEX®, GD: Reminder that OEKO-TEX® is happy to help and support RISE to bring the STeP certification closer to the customer à possible travel of AM to Sweden?

5.15 Shirley

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	Ca. 1450	439
LEATHER STANDARD		1
STeP (active cert.)	33 (little new certificates)	-
MADE IN GREEN	2394 labels (289 MIG customers, 34 Label owner)	-
ECO PASSPORT	30	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

Success Story:

- Dunelm Project (100 % of bed linen department)
- John Lewis (5th biggest retailer in the UK)
- Wimbledon towels (MADE IN GREEN labelled) a great Marketing opportunity

Targets

- Push ECO PASSPORT

Marketing:

- Seminars activities strong

Challenges:

- Shirley is still catching up regarding audits due to the pandemic
- Work from home, part time work, Inflation 10% (weak pound)

Suggestions, questions, comments:

CENTROCOT, GC and all others: Interested how Shirley is handling the contact to big brands

OEKO-TEX®, IB: It would be great to get more insights to the success stories from Shirley on working with big brands (Wimbledon etc.)

TESTEX, JH: Were prices increases needed by Shirley due to the crisis?

- ➔ Feedback SHIRLEY, SD: yes

5.16 STFI:

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	365 (of which are 16 first certifications)	39

General Information:

- OEKO-TEX® number of pre-certified materials is increasing
- Investing in face mask testing (great chance for research, as equipment can be used within the research area)

Competences of STFI:

- Fibre nonwoven development
- Processing of glass, carbon etc…
- Active member of Textranet, as a success story

5.17 TESTEX

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	6559 (decrease compared to last year)	1391
LEATHER STANDARD	10	3
STeP (active cert.)	155 (increase compared to last year)	-
MADE IN GREEN	57 (Number of labelowner)	-
ECO PASSPORT	364	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

- Presents great progress in lab digitalization and automation
- New orbitraps
- Steady in STANDARD 100, due to covid situation
- No big increase in LEATHER STANDARD, also struggling

Marketing:

- Jubilee of 175 years TESTEX
- Taking part in the Sustainable Development Goals, to support and push throughout the industry
- Co Stakeholder in Sustainable Textiles Switzerland
- Signing Charta in Circular Economy
- Social Media activities are running and increasing
- Fairs and Seminars are running in China and other countries
- TESTEX is active in more than 15 associations, NGOs etc.

Success Stories:

- Biweekly meeting with Shirley to exchange business developments ideas
- Positive Feedback regarding the Impact Calculator
- Good collaboration in Working Groups

Challenges:

- OEKO-TEX® digital customer experience still without solutions and with many delays in projects
- Protect core products while keeping pace with new requirements (regulations in Europe)

5.18 Vutch

OEKO-TEX® Product	Certificates issued / users registered from 07/2021 to 06/2022	Audits from 07/2021 to 06/2022
STANDARD 100	25	4
LEATHER STANDARD	-	-
STeP (active cert.)	-	-
MADE IN GREEN	-	-
ECO PASSPORT	-	-
DETOX TO ZERO	-	-

General information:

Targets:

- Increase Webinars to spread the word
- Closer communication with clients

Challenges:

- Finding trained and educated experts in the textile business is not easy

Success stories

- Changed management
- Extraordinary Audit by OEKO-TEX® secretariat with positive feedback

6. Circular Economy

6.1 General Input

Main information: See presentation slide 24 - 30

- Proposal Brand Responsibility (slide 26): Accepted
- Proposal Circular production (slide 27): Accepted
- Proposal Longevity (slide 28): Accepted
- Proposal to establish 2 additional Working groups - for Longevity and Circular Economy: Accepted

Suggestions, questions, comments:

RISE, CJ: Coexisting with other initiative especially the digital product passport. Labels should be used to get into the passport or to verify the compliance.
TESTEX, JH: Competitor do not necessarily cover quality (only shrinkage)
IFTH, CR: Longevity is a topic studied by IFTH and there is certain experience, interested into knowledge exchange.
CENTROCOT, GC: Every country will have an own solution to be compliant with EU, longevity also has to do with Eco-design. Concerning circular production, we must involve different sectors which we currently do not cover.
CITEVE, BC: Avoid mixing of quality and level of longevity
AITEX, VB: OEKO-TEX® is a business and the quality and longevity is not in the focus of the system, difficult to ensure conformity over the year.
HTTI, SD: There are many customers who are controlling their quality and protocols are available. A protocol should be available, whether it is within the STANDARD100.
CENTEXBEL, JL: How can things be repaired should also be considered.
DTI, JR: Add on for STANDARD100 possible?

To Do all institutes:
Please let OEKO-TEX® secretariat know if there are experts that want to join the working group!

7. Recycled Material

Main information: see presentation slide 31- 32
Interested persons should contact OEKO-TEX®

8. Microplastic

Main information: see presentation presented by Dr Timo Hammer, Hohenstein
TESTEX, MB: Microplastic is a big problem, in March Electrolux has launched a filtering washing machines

- ➔ HTTI, TH: Electronic suppliers and wastewater treatment are taking steps to filter out microplastic. This is a good idea; however filter capacity and filter cleaning might be an issue.

IFTH, CR: There is a legal requirement that before January 2025 any washing machine will need to have a filter to catch microplastic

- ➔ HTTI, TH: Good business for machine producers as filter will need to be changed regularly

CENTEXBEL, JL: Microplastics are also an issue within production, could it be implemented into STeP. ECHA has defined Microfiber size, are the methods able to track these

- ➔ HTTI, TH: Method to Hohenstein does not go all the way down to 3nm

DTI, JR: Number of fibres in comparison to kg does not connect

- ➔ HTTI, TH: True, data out in the system is not conclusive.

CENTROCOT, GC: What is the technical position of the laboratory for testing micro plastic

- ➔ HTTI, TH: Testing dynamic imaging is recommended, they also do comparison study usually. Also aging of the product should be considered.

TESTEX, JH: Far away from standardization, if we want to take it up, then STeP could be the best option. Variability of microfiber plastic release is very high, not sure whether there can be added anything in the standards

9. Legal

9.1 Brand protection

OEKO-TEX® trademarks are all registered as individual marks. Certification marks: can be used by various companies to identify services. A Regulation will be published on OEKO-TEX® website starting 2023.

9.2 Data protection

Data protection law in Switzerland has been revised and comes into effect in 2023.

9.3 ISO accreditation

ISO 17065 - conformity assessment for competence for service processes.
ISO 17065 shows independency of the certification bodies towards scheme owners.
ISO 17065 is required by Green Button 2.0 for all recognized certification and labels.

Suggestions, questions, comments:

CITEVE, BC: The accreditation shall be considered upfront according to info from authorities. If institute offers consultancy, services, etc. the institute cannot be recognized by ISO 17065 - instead should be offered by an independent company.
CENTEXBEL, JL: there is no need to create a new company as suggested and said to be required by Citeve.

OEKO-TEX®, GD: Proposal that all who do not have the accreditation, shall evaluate a plan how to cover the required accreditation - definition "roadmap" and definition of requirements.
OEKO-TEX®, GD: OEKO-TEX® will send an invitation asap.

Deadline for the ISO 17065 accreditation is August 2023 (according to requirement to Green Button).

9.4 Declaration of Conformity

Reg. ISO 17050 requirements – Documents will be updated early 2023.

9.5 Grievance Mechanism

Suggestions, questions, comments:

CITEVE, BC: How must the Grievance mechanism be integrated?

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, GD: All OEKO-TEX® institutes must create a link on their website towards the OEKO-TEX® grievance mechanism.

RISE, CJ: Suggestion to have a general/uniform information about the link that will be posted.
SHIRLEY, SD: Grievance mechanisms procedure shall be clear to all institutes - the process should be introduced and transparent.

10. Strategy orientation in the fashion industry

10.1 General information

Main information: see presentation presented by Coty Jeronimus, Quantis
Quantis is presenting a selection of upcoming regulations under the Green Deal. (see slide 21)
What is the Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive and its impact?

- ➔ It contributes to extend the Green Deal to other sectors (see slide 26 what indicators are covered). It will concern all large companies and all companies listed on regulated markets, micro companies and SMEs are not of concern yet.
- ➔ It is crucial for OEKO-TEX® to respond to the Green Deal, but has big opportunities.

10.2 Q&A

AITEX, VB: What is Quantis suggesting to implementing these requirements and support the customer? How can OEKO-TEX® take up these bigger parts and support the member becoming more sustainable and follow these requirements?

CENTEXBEL, JL: How can PESTEL be understood and how can we integrate and learn from others?

- ➔ QUANTIS, CJ: collaborations is key to respond to the upcoming challenges

HTTI, SM: Why it is critical for OEKO-TEX® regarding Green Deal?

- ➔ QUANTIS, CJ: brands are struggling and don't know what is coming, so it is the role of OEKO-TEX® to support with these new requirements and see the big opportunities.

IFTH, CR: How can other brands be penalized (like SHINE) which are growing at the moment in comparison to others that have certifications in place and follow good practices.

- ➔ QUANTIS, CJ: Certifications are good practice for companies, but it is much more important to impact. There should be tags on products and LCA/measuring impacts to really achieve the goal.

IFTH, CR: focus on good practices is missing and this is the key road of the EU to sustainability.

CENTROCOT, GC: customers want to have a comparison on GRI and STeP.

- ➔ QUANTIS, CJ: These are two different things and indicators covered. STeP certification has a different approach.
- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, GD: we will look into how we can support this need

CITEVE, BC: What are the impacts of the ECO Label on OEKO-TEX®, will there be any cannibalization?

- ➔ QUANTIS, CJ: depending on the development on the label, but OEKO-TEX® is already covering a lot of aspects.
- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, GD: various comparisons have been done and will also be shared with the institutes, but we as OEKO-TEX® are covering much deeper aspects already.

11. Product Development

11.1 Technical Updates 2023 (RSL/MRSL)

In the following only the results are documented.

Substances under observation:

- Slide 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74– Substances under observation – Accepted
- FILK, HS: what is meant by Diisocyanats?
- OEKO-TEX®, DK: none, mistake on the slide.
- N-ethyl-2-pyrrolidone 2687-91-4 – Accepted
- Drometrizole 2440-22-0 - Accepted
- PerFluoroCarboxylic Acids (PFCA) – new EU regulations – Accepted

PFC/PFAS

- PFC/PFAS – Total organic fluorine content (see proposal on Slide 80)- Accepted
  - ➔ HTTI, SD: There are fluorinated dyes, in case they are used à no intentional use, therefore should be allowed. Careful with the terminology, as only total organic fluorine content of PFCs/PFAS should be affected.

SVHCs

- Tris(2-methoxyethoxy)vinylsilane (CAS: 1067-53-4) - Accepted
- 6,6'-di-tert-butyl-2,2'-methylenedi-p-cresol (CAS: 119-47-1) - Accepted
- N-(hydroxymethyl)acrylamide (CAS: 924-42-5) - Accepted
- Dipropyltin 867-36-7 - Accepted

- Inclusion of the 48 pesticides in the ORGANIC COTTON
  - ➔ RISE, CJ: how will this impact the non-organic cotton?
  - ➔ OEKO-TEX®, DK: not done yet, but first data will be gathered. Next year data based decisions will be made.
  - ➔ HTTI, SD: not worried at all
- Methylethylketone (MEK) 78-93-3 - Accepted

ECO PASSPORT:

- Thiourea & AEEA - Accepted
- ZDHC MRSL 3.0 – Implementation of all new substances from the ZDHC MRSL 3.0 into the ECO PASSPORT RSL by April 2023 - Accepted
- Trimethyl phosphate (Intermediate in chemical industry) 512-56-1 - Accepted
- Inclusion in ECO PASSPORT under "PFCs, per and polyfluorinated compounds" (see slide 95) - Accepted
- ZDHC MRSL 3.0 (Borate, zinc salt) -Inclusion in ECO PASSPORT under "Other Chemicals" with 1'000 mg/kg threshold – Accepted

STANDARD 100:

- Proposal of Commission business (slide 98) - Accepted
- Perfumes / Fragrances/Scents – Accepted
- pH exception for wet wipes – Accepted
- MCCP & SCCP limit value - Accepted

11.2 OEKO-TEX® ORGANIC COTTON

Main information: see presentation

Suggestions, questions, comments:

TESTEX, MB: How can we compete against GOTS?

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, GD: Certificate holders of GOTS are unsatisfied and big brands are asking OEKO-TEX® to cover this field.
- ➔ HTTI, SD: slow response times from GOTs, customers are not satisfied à risk is minimal and HTTI believes a lot in the opportunities
- ➔ CITEVE, BC: feedback of customers is good regarding GOTS

CENTROCOT, GC: a lot of institutes can issue certificates for GOTS, Textile Exchange etc., how to handle this situation?

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, GD: The focus is on OEKO-TEX® and the institutes must drop the activities for GOTS and others.
- ➔ HTTI, SD: One part of this exercise is to improve the organic certification, how do we tackle the material flow problem etc.

SHIRLEY, SD: How is pricing on 100% and > 70%, what is the USP?

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, DK: Pricing will be discussed further and communicated at a later stage

TESTEX, JPH: How to calculate the pricing with transaction certificates?

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, DK: discussions are ongoing. In pilot phase they are for free . For the launch the additional administrative work will be connected to a pricing proposal as well.

11.3 OEKO-TEX® RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS

General Information:

- Please see presentation slide 95 - 106 for information.
- Self-Assessment consists of around 200 questions. Answering these questions lead into an unvalidated report without a certification. After that step the company can decide to proceed with the certification process that includes audits and the validation of the provided answers.
- RESPONSIBLE BUSINSESS will facilitate potential communication with authorities.

Facts & Figures:

- The cost of certification depends on the extent to which the company has already integrated human rights and environmental due diligence into its management processes.

Suggestions, questions, comments:

OETI, RL: Man Days should be around 1000 Euro – highly educated people are needed, as well considering the inflation

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, GD: start with this price range as this was agreed with group. Look for the next 12 month and learnings and might adjust

SHIRLEY, SD: Risk of report – the report will be legally analysed

IFTH, CR: Important topic for France and want to learn more about the content of the Standard.

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, MT: Give examples of what a business company needs to do, e.g. Risk Analysis in the supply chain
- ➔ RISE: How do we find solutions for that?

AITEX, VB / CENTROCOT, GC: Can manufacturer or production facilities apply for RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS as well?

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, MT: Yes, in general everybody can apply – but it is particularly built to support brands or retailer. It will be discussed in the RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS Working Group

TESTEX, JH: Clarification that RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS is not a product label. It will never be visible on a product in a store.

11.4 Digitalisation

General

See presentation for project overview and status quo

- Contact Sönke Giebeler or OEKO-TEX Product Management Team to get more details about certain projects
- Strategic IT meeting with OETI, Testex and HTTI took place on 13th October to align the digital strategy
- New OEKO-TEX Head of Digitalisation Petriina Piuhola will shape the strategy and lead all IT- and digitalisation-related projects as of now
- Focus: Customer centric projects and need for a new system that makes future improvements possible and faster
- Implications: business development projects and products (ORGANIC COTTON, Recycling, RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS, Impact calculation) are affected and will not be supported with an extensive IT solution in the short-term

Online Application & Impact Calculator

- For OEKO-TEX® the online application is the major priority right now (coupled with improving quality of customer data in the current system)
- The Impact Calculator already is and will be a booster for the STeP certification (feedback from audience)

The BHive®

- Great solution for auditors and customer for chemical management
- Improved data quality, goal is to have all STeP customer on board: see slides in presentation
- Next step: implementation and go-live April 2023

Suggestions, questions, comments:

CITEVE, BC: for the online application it is important to understand how the online application will be integrated into the institute processes and IT systems

CENTROCOT, GC: Can the company, if they use BHive directly upload to the ZDHC gateway?

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, SG: Yes this is possible. Customer can use BHive to generate ZDHC InCheck reports (additional ZDHC related cost involved). This is an advantage for customers and a benefit for OEKO-TEX® in terms of ZDHC acknowledgment for their programs (e.g. Supplier to Zero).

- CENTROCOT, GC: received an offer to pay 25.000 € to connect with the ZDHC database.
  - OEKO-TEX®, SG: If you get these kind of offer, please get in touch with Alisia and Sönke, since we are working on a an approach applicable and beneficial for the whole OEKO-TEX® Association.

12. Marketing

12.1 OEKO-TEX® Repositioning Update

See presentation for main information

Outcome of the feedback survey regarding the new logo: more visible, clean, simple

- ➔ Inga: any support needed towards the institutes for rebranding / updating institutes website? No particular feedback here from the participants.

12.2 Fairs & events Outlook 2023

TESTEX, MB: fairs etc, faced damage through corona – OEKO-TEX® should support for the most relevant fairs, but possibly rather strengthen the webinars/online events, Having a bigger reach than fairs. Possibly to contribute to smaller fairs?
SHIRLEY, SD: Shirley doesn't see the attendance to fairs as directly linked to the acquisition of new customers.
CITEVE, BC: international fairs are important for OEKO-TEX® as competitors are there. We must be there to promote OEKO-TEX®. Further, big fairs are attracting important customers. BC votes for attending the bigger fairs, necessary for promoting OT products.
OEKO-TEX® IB: Institutes should use our presence on fairs to connect with customers.
RISE, LJÖ: Webinars to be reinforced and more frequently offered. Review the need for fair platforms for new products such as RESPONSIBLE BUSINESS.
CENTEXBEL, JL: look into digital Trends such as Metaverse and how those technologies can be adapted by OEKO-TEX®.

13. On-Site-Visit/Audit Management

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

14. Quality Management

14.1 Control Test

TESTEX, JPH: If Centexbel is accredited for control testing, maybe we can harmonize our approach better.

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, ER will reach out to CENTEXBEL to discuss the potential.

TESTEX, JPH: practical insights on the data analysis would be helpful for the institutes, e.g. are the trends for a certain region or certain article group to fail often, then institutes present in that region should be informed.

- ➔ OEKO-TEX®, ER: Will provide the information to the technicians.

14.2 Control Test 22/23

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

TESTEX, JPH: OEKO-TEX® shall make sure to share the correct numbers, the presented ones are different from the shared ones.

➔ OEKO-TEX®, ER will add a mark to the correct numbers and share them again.

14.3 Round Robin Test

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

14.4 Institute Audits

IFTH, CR will share the group picture with OEKO-TEX®, ER

14.5 On-Site Visits and Self-Assessments STANDARD100

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

14.6 Spot Visits

The presented information was well perceived and no comments or questions were raised.

15. Finances

The numbers and results of the OEKO-TEX Service GmbH were presented. All results were verified by independent accountants. They have been accepted without objection.

16. Institute`s Expectations of OEKO-TEX® Secretariat Zurich

CITEVE, BC: Working groups are the right channels to contribute to the work of the secretariat.
CITEVE, BC: Coffee break in the afternoon of the second day was missing

17. Various

- The next General Manager meeting will be held on the 26-27th October 2023 in Budapest.
- Thank you for the successful meeting. Warm thank you to the members of the different working groups.

The meeting was closed, 21st October 3:45 pm.